ME 5309 – Mid-Semester Examination

Answer Booklet

Instructions: Attempt any three questions. Each question carries 10 marks. Show working where appropriate.

Question 2 [10 marks]

Q2(a) [2 marks]

Choose $x_1 = \theta$ and $x_2 = \dot{\theta}$. Then $\dot{x}_1 = x_2$ and $\dot{x}_2 = [\tau - b\, x_2 - mg\ell \sin(x_1)]/J$. At equilibrium:

$$x_2 = 0 and_0 = mg\ell sin\theta_e$$

Since $|\sin \theta_e|$ less than or equal to 1, an equilibrium exists when $|\tau_0|$ less than or equal to $mg\ell = 2.4525$ N m.

At rest $\dot{\theta} = 0$ and $\ddot{\theta} = 0$, so the damping term vanishes. Rearranging gives $\tau_0 = mg\ell \sin\theta_e$. Here $mg\ell = 1 \times 9.81 \times 0.25 = 2.4525$ N m. Since $-1 \leq \sin\theta_e \leq 1$, the required torque must lie between -2.4525 and $+2.4525$ N m.

Q2(b) [2 marks]

$$A = [[0, 1], [-61.3125, -2.5]], B = [[0], [50]]$$

Q2(c) [4 marks]

At rest, $\dot{\theta} = \ddot{\theta} = 0$, so the torque balance is $K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss}) = mg\ell \sin\theta_{ss}$. With $K_p = 50$, $\theta_d = \pi/2$ and $mg\ell = 2.4525$, solve $50(\pi/2 - \theta_{ss}) = 2.4525 \sin\theta_{ss}$. This gives θ_{ss} approximately 1.52181 rad = 87.193°, so the error is 90°-87.193° = 2.807°; it is not zero.

Rearranging the steady-state equation gives $50(\pi/2 - \theta_{ss}) = 2.4525 \sin\theta_{ss}$. I used radians in the equation. Solving numerically gives $\theta_{ss} \approx 1.522$ rad $\approx 87.19°$, so the gap from $90°$ is about $2.81°$.

Q2(d) [2 marks]

With gravity compensation, the gravity term cancels the plant's $mg\ell \sin\theta$ term. At rest, $K_p(\theta_d - \theta_{ss})=0$, so $\theta_{ss}=\theta_d$ and the steady-state error is zero. The linearised gravity stiffness term is also cancelled, so the closed-loop poles generally change; the stiffness contribution $mg\ell \cos\theta_d$ is removed.

The compensation term cancels the nominal gravity torque in the plant model. At steady state the proportional term must then be zero, which requires $\theta_d - \theta_{ss} = 0$. This does not mean the transient response is unchanged: removing the gravity derivative changes the linearized stiffness.

Question 3 [10 marks]

Q3(a) [2 marks]

Q3(b) [2 marks]

Tustin uses s = (2/T)(z-1)/(z+1).

Q3(c) [4 marks]

A-LC=[[-ℓ_1,1], [-ℓ_2,-2]]. The desired polynomial is $(s+10)^2 = s^2+20s+100$.

Q3(d) [2 marks]

The observer is better and the filter is safer in some cases.

Question 4 [10 marks]

Q4(a) [2 marks]

Closed-loop characteristic polynomial is $s^2+(a+bk_2)s+(c+bk_1)=s^2+4s+8$, giving poles -2±2j. At DC, θ/r = bNff/(c+bk₁), so unity gain requires Nff=(c+bk₁)/b=(6+2)/1=8.

Comparing coefficients with $s^2 + 4s + 8$ gives $a + bk_2 = 4$ and $c + bk_1 = 8$. The feedforward gain is chosen from the nominal plant so the reference scaling is unity; here this gives $N_{ff} = 8$. The closed-loop roots of $s^2 + 4s + 8$ are $-2 \pm 2j$.

Q4(b) [2 marks]

$$\theta_{ss} = 0.75 \times 8/(6 + 2) = 0.75,$$

the percentage tracking error is 25%

Q4(c) [4 marks]

The characteristic polynomial is $s^3+(a+bk_2)s^2+(c+bk_1)s+bK_I$. I use the target $s^3+6s^2+12s+16$, giving $k_2=4$, $k_1=6$, K_I=16.

Q4(d) [2 marks]